Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition
GO Expansion Operations
Metrolinx, Toronto, ON

Re: Senior Manager, GO Expansion Operations

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Manager, GO Expansion Operations position. I worked at Metrolinx in 2023 as a Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling, in Service Design, and since January 2024 I have been an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward. I assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes, and worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions, presenting the evidence behind them. Reviewing corridor projects through an operations lens is close to that work.

At the City I run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, write the briefing notes that come out of them, and present to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions. I coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.

I should be straightforward about the gaps, which are large for a role at this level. The posting asks for ten years of progressively senior experience in railway operations, corridor engineering and contract management; I have about four and a half years in total, one of them in rail. I have not managed staff, applied collective agreement provisions, or managed vendors or capital budgets, and I do not hold CROR certification or a P.Eng. If the team has a role closer to my level, I would welcome being considered for it.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

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